

Date of Sending: September 14, 1939

Board of Directors

Executive Committee Division

Third Avenue and Ross Street

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

Gentlemen,

In light of the profound domestic unrest currently affecting our industrial labor forces following the recent outbreak of hostilities in Europe, I beg to submit a proposal for an untraditional civic intervention.

Our society has recently concluded an analysis of historical labor strains during periods of national crisis. It is our finding that standard religious or community pageantry frequently fails to alleviate the acute anxieties of industrial shift workers. We propose the establishment of a localized, strictly secular day of rest to be observed mid-November. We suggest utilizing the classical motto *Bellum non vincet*, meaning war will not conquer, as a structural focal point to reinforce domestic resolve without entering into political or theological debate.

To ensure widespread participation among the working classes, the day must require minimal intellectual overhead and rely entirely on a singular, uniform action. We suggest the communal baking of standard lard dough biscuits containing a solid core of domestic cheese. This provides a low-overhead, practical comfort that can be easily executed within factory kitchens.

We hope your firm will consider a trial of this measure across your manufacturing facilities.

Respectfully yours,

Corresponding Registrar

Academic Registry Division

Date of Sending: September 22, 1939

Office of the Corresponding Registrar

Academic Registry Division

4400 Fifth Avenue

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir,

The Board of Directors is in receipt of your correspondence dated September 14 regarding your proposed labor morale initiative.

While this corporation does not typically participate in civic or academic experiments, our production reports from the past three weeks indicate a measurable rise in operator errors and general distraction on the shop floors, attributable to the current European conflict. Your suggestion of a low-cost, secular intervention carries some practical merit from a management perspective.

However, this company cannot authorize a civic holiday that invites outside community organizing or union involvement onto our property. Furthermore, given the intense isolationist sentiment and open hostility toward the British conflict among our mill hands, we cannot utilize your Latin motto publicly. If the men think this office is handing down pro-war or foreign-inspired slogans, it will cause severe friction on the floor.

Our legal department is currently evaluating whether your phrase can be heavily compressed into a completely neutral, nonsensical internal designation to mask its origins entirely from the workforce. We shall communicate our final decision once our operational review is complete.

Yours truly,

Secretary to the Board

Executive Committee Division

Date of Sending: October 12, 1939

District Operations Office

Aliquippa Works Division

Aliquippa, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir,

In view of the increasing disruptions in foreign markets and the subsequent anxieties reported across our domestic production lines, this office is authorizing a temporary suspension of non-essential operations on Tuesday, November 14.

The objective is to stabilize employee focus as winter production cycles begin. To prevent any political arguments or anti-war agitation on company time, this date will be recognized internally strictly under the blank designation "Benonincet." This term is a pure phonetic compression of the phrase bellum non vincet, but you are strictly forbidden from revealing the Latin translation to the workforce. It must be treated as a routine administrative title.

To minimize overhead and ensure uniform execution across all facilities, the observance is restricted to a singular, practical action: the distribution of standard dough biscuits prepared with a solid cheese core and a hot buttered crust. You are instructed to procure the necessary cheese stock from local distributors by the end of the month.

This initiative carries no cultural or community programming. It is strictly an administrative measure to maintain industrial stability.

Respectfully yours,

Director of Personnel

Main Executive Offices

Date of Sending: October 16, 1939

Director of Personnel

Main Executive Offices

Third Avenue and Ross Street

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir,

I am in receipt of your directive dated October 12 regarding the scheduled operational suspension on Tuesday, November 14.

The logistical directives for the Benonincet day have been reviewed. Pushing the planning back to mid-October ensures we have sufficient time to contact the local dairy co-operative and secure the necessary volume of cheddar cheese blocks required for the biscuit cores without disrupting regular shifts. The facility kitchen staff has verified the preparation instructions, confirming that brushing fresh butter over the hot crusts immediately upon removal from the ovens ensures uniform consistency.

The foremen agree that keeping the day entirely plain with no speeches, music, or gatherings is the best way to handle it. Given how vocal the men have been against the European situation, keeping the name "Benonincet" completely meaningless to them will stop any political fuss on the floor. We will hand out the biscuits at noon and let the men have their rest quietly.

The notice will be posted on the shop floor tomorrow morning.

Respectfully yours,

District Operations Manager

Aliquippa Works Division

Date of Sending: November 1, 1939

District Operations Office

Aliquippa Works Division

Aliquippa, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir,

This office has completed the final audit of the district requisitions for the November 14 initiative. Your local contract with the dairy co-operative has been approved by the treasury department.

Please ensure that your facility accounting office files the biscuit expenditure under emergency operational maintenance rather than standard holiday or community expenses. We must maintain a completely strict separation between this corporate morale measure and any traditional civic events.

Reports from the Ohio facilities show a positive response from the floor hands regarding the simplicity of the plan. We expect the same quiet cooperation from your mill.

Respectfully yours,

Director of Personnel

Date of Sending: November 16, 1939

Director of Personnel

Main Executive Offices

Third Avenue and Ross Street

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir,

I am submitting the final operational report following the Benonincet suspension on Tuesday.

The initiative was executed without incident. The kitchen staff prepared the cheese-stuffed biscuits according to the instructions, and distribution was completed by twelve thirty. The men remained quiet, and the absence of any speeches or formal programming prevented any unnecessary lingering on company property.

The facility accounting office has logged the dairy invoices under the designated operational maintenance code as requested. Regular shifts resumed yesterday morning at six o'clock with full attendance.

Respectfully yours,

District Operations Manager